

A

Asking someone for their opinion**What do you think of** his new book / Tom's girlfriend? (asking about a specific thing or person)**What do you think about** global warming / cosmetic surgery? (asking about a general topic)**How do you feel about** working with the others?

B

Introducing your own opinion**Personally, I think** Helena was probably right.**Personally, I feel** that we should increase the price.**In my opinion** [I think], we need to change the direction of the company.**My view/feeling is** [my opinion is] that we need to wait a bit longer.Common **mistakes**Personally, I **don't think it's** a good idea. (NOT I think it's ~~not~~ a good idea.)**In my opinion**, motorbikes are dangerous. (NOT ~~On~~ my opinion OR In my ~~meaning~~)In most situations, it is probably easier and more natural to use **personally**.

C

Giving the opinion of othersThe newspaper **says** that his death was not an accident. (NOT ~~It's written~~ in the newspaper)**According to** the paper [the paper says], the government didn't know about it.

D

Agreeing and disagreeing (with someone)I **totally agree (with you)** [agree completely, 100%].I **partly agree (with you)** [agree but not completely].I **agree (with you) to a certain extent** [partly agree].Common **mistakes**I **agree** with you. (NOT I'm agree with you.)**Do you agree?** (NOT ~~Are you~~ agree?)

In British English, it is common to agree with someone before giving a different opinion.

That's true, but I think ...**I see what you mean**, [I understand what you are saying] but ...**I agree to some extent, but** ...I think that's a good **point** [idea or opinion], **but** ...I **take your point** [I understand and partly agree with your opinion], **but** ...

E

Giving a strong opinion

I **feel very strongly about** military service.
I think everyone should do it.



I think you're **absolutely right/**
wrong [100% correct/wrong].



I don't agree **at all**
[I completely disagree].



I **disagree completely** [100%
don't agree].



Exercises

67.1 Complete the questions in different ways to ask people their opinion.

- 1 What do you think *about* sending people to Mars?
- 2 these shoes? Do you like them?
- 3 having more responsibility?

67.2 Complete the dialogues.

- 1 A: Did you think he was right in what he said?
B: Not completely, but I *partly* agreed with him.
- 2 A: What did you think the film?
B: Well, I didn't like it.
- 3 A: Do you agree with her?
B: Yes, to a certain
- 4 A: She feels very about protecting the environment.
B: Yes, I know, and I think she's absolutely
- 5 A:, I think all politicians tell lies.
B: Sorry, but I completely.
- 6 A: We can't send everyone to university.
B: Yes, that's, but we should give everyone a chance to go.
- 7 A: My is that we should make all chocolate and sweets more expensive, and then people couldn't afford to eat so many things that are bad for them.
B: That's a good, but it seems unfair on people who don't eat too many sweet things.
- 8 A: I see what you about spending more money, but can we afford it?
B: Well, in my we have no choice.

67.3 Rewrite the sentences using the words in capitals. Keep a similar meaning.

- 1 I think you're right. AGREE *I agree with you.*
- 2 I think the club needs new players. OPINION
- 3 I completely disagree with you. AT ALL
- 4 The newspaper says the fire was started on purpose. ACCORDING
- 5 I partly agree with her. EXTENT
- 6 I see what you mean, but I'm not sure I agree. POINT

67.4 Over to you

Respond to the statements with your own opinion. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

- 1 I think most women are happy to stay at home and be a mother and housewife.
.....
- 2 Personally I don't think the government should give so much money to people who don't work.
.....
- 3 My feeling is that we should give more money to poor countries in other parts of the world.
.....
- 4 I think we should make it more expensive to drive a car in order to reduce the number of cars.
.....